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THE AMERICANS ARE COMING!

Every major piece of intelligence that Nikita Khrushchev received on Friday, October 26, suggested that the Americans were getting ready for a major military action that would start with an invasion of Cuba. That day, military intelligence reports conveying information on the preparation of US hospitals for possible casualties were supplemented by information from KGB officers and diplomats stationed in Washington. Some of it was supplied by the ambassador himself.

The previous day, Anatoly Dobrynin had sent an urgent cable to Moscow: “This night (around 3 o’clock in the morning Washington time) our journalist […] was at the bar of the press club of Washington where usually many correspondents gather. Barman approached him […] and whispered that he had overheard a conversation of two prominent American journalists (Donovan and Rogers) that the President had supposedly taken a decision to invade Cuba today or tomorrow night. Our correspondent also had an opportunity to talk to Rogers, a correspondent of the *New York*